

Death At Dawn In Damascus:

SYRIA HANGS ISREALI 'SPIES'

As the citizens of Damascus stirred and went about their business at dawn a grim spectacle met them as they passed through the city's Al-Marja Square - the bodies of three men hanging from the scaffold, wrapped round their bodies, covering them from neck to feet were wide sacks, on which the text of the court's verdict was stitched.

They were Jamil el-Kark, a Lebanese born Syrian Protestant lay preacher, and two men alleged to be his chief lieutenants - Jamil Haddad, a sergeant in the Syrian army, and Yussef Laktinah. All three had been sentenced to death only eight hours earlier by a court martial, which tried 11 people on charges of spying for Israel. It was alleged that the spy ring operated from 1954 to 1961. The prosecution said that radio sets fixed inside holy statues were used by the spies to send information to Israel.

El-Kark's wife was one of the accused and received fifteen years hard labour.

With the other countries of the Arab world, Syria still considers herself at war with Israel. Her vengeance on those she believes helps the enemy can be brutal, as is shown by these pictures.

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